

Mind Space — UI/UX Design Brief

Document 04 of 06 | Version 1.0 | PFE Project

Aesthetic direction

"A quiet room that remembers you." Dark, warm, intimate. Not clinical. Not cheerful. The visual language should feel like late-night journaling in a space that is safe and unhurried. Every interaction should feel considered, never rushed. The app is competing with the best consumer apps (Calm, Notion, Linear) — not with student projects.

One-line brief:

Dark-first, editorial typography, micro-animated spirits, zero visual noise.

Color palette

Token	Hex	Usage
--bg-primary	#0D0D0D	Main background. Near-black, not pure black.
--bg-card	#151517	Card and sheet backgrounds. Slightly lifted from bg.
--bg-elevated	#1C1C1F	Modals, bottom sheets, elevated surfaces.
--text-primary	#F5F5F7	Primary text. Off-white, not pure white.
--text-secondary	#9B9BA0	Secondary text, labels, metadata.
--text-tertiary	#5A5A60	Hints, disabled states, dev labels.
--accent-purple	#6C5CE7	Primary CTA, Arc color default, active state.
--accent-green	#00C48C	Calm emotion, success states, archive CTA.
--accent-orange	#F39C12	Frustrated/anxious emotions, warnings.
--accent-blue	#5B8DEF	Sad emotion, info states.
--accent-red	#E74C3C	Destructive actions, crisis indicator dot.
--border	#2A2A2E	Card borders, dividers. 0.5px, never thicker.

Typography

Role	Font	Size	Weight	Usage
Display	SF Pro Display / Inter	34–40sp	700	Screen titles: "History", "Morning, Seya."

Role	Font	Size	Weight	Usage
Heading	SF Pro Display / Inter	22–28sp	600	Section headings, Arc names, card titles
Body	SF Pro Text / Inter	16–18sp	400	Chat messages, reflection content, body text
Label	SF Pro Text / Inter	12–14sp	500	Emotion tags, metadata, timestamps
Caption	SF Pro Text / Inter	11–12sp	400	Dev labels (debug mode only), fine print
Mono	SF Mono / JetBrains Mono	13–14sp	400	Processing stage labels, technical states

Note: Flutter uses Google Fonts. Use Inter as the system-wide fallback. Load via google_fonts package.

Emotion spirits

The emotion spirit is the central visual metaphor of the app. It is an animated orb, not an emoji or a face. It pulses, breathes, and shifts. It should feel like internal weather, not a cartoon reaction.

Spirit	Color	Hex	Animation	Usage context
Anxious	Purple	#6C5CE7	Fast, irregular pulse. Slightly chaotic.	Fear, performance pressure, uncertainty
Calm	Green	#00C48C	Slow, steady breath. 3s cycle.	Clarity, resolution, morning check-ins
Frustrated	Orange	#F39C12	Medium pulse, warm glow.	Blocked, annoyed, people-pleasing
Sad	Blue	#5B8DEF	Slow, drooping pulse. Cool hue.	Loss, grief, loneliness
Hopeful	Yellow-Green	#A8E063	Rising, brightening animation.	Growth, anticipation, perspective shift
Overwhelmed	Red-Orange	#E17055	Multiple rapid pulses, unstable.	Too much, overload, burnout

First-time user education: on first encounter with any spirit, a one-time micro-tooltip appears below the orb: "[Color] = [Emotion name]". Disappears after 3 seconds. Never shown again.

Component library

Cards

- Border-radius: 16px (--radius-lg)
- Background: --bg-card
- Border: 0.5px solid --border
- Padding: 16px horizontal, 14px vertical
- No drop shadows — elevation is expressed through color, not shadow

Buttons

- Primary CTA: full-width, 54px height, border-radius 12px, --accent-purple fill, --text-primary text
- Secondary: border only (0.5px --border), transparent fill, --text-primary text
- Destructive: border-only, --accent-red border and text
- Ghost: no border, --text-secondary text, used for "← Arcs" breadcrumb links

Bottom sheets

- Background: --bg-elevated
- Top corners only: border-radius 20px
- Handle bar: 4px wide, 32px long, --text-tertiary color, centered, 8px from top
- Never use rounded corners on the bottom — sheet reaches the edge

Navigation

- Bottom tab bar: --bg-card background, no border line, icon + label
- Active state: --accent-purple icon + label
- Inactive state: --text-tertiary icon + label
- Center FAB (+): --accent-purple, 56px diameter, no label

Micro-interactions

Interaction	Animation	Haptic
Send message	User bubble slides in from right (150ms, ease-out)	Light impact
Sage reply arrives (first token)	No animation — streaming IS the reveal	None
Reflection screen appears	Cascade: spirit fades in (300ms) → what Sage heard (200ms delay) → question (400ms delay) → Arc update (600ms delay)	Medium impact on spirit reveal
Arc card tap	Brief scale to 0.97 then release (100ms)	Selection feedback
Generate insight tap	Button pulses once, then loading state	Light impact

Interaction	Animation	Haptic
Archive Arc	Card fades and dims (400ms), moves to archived section	Success notification
Emotion spirit (home)	Continuous ambient breath animation. 3–5s cycle. Never stops.	None

Dark mode specification

The app is dark-mode only in v1. There is no light mode toggle. This is a deliberate product decision — the intimate, introspective context of the app calls for a dark environment, and building both modes in 15 days is out of scope.

Screen-specific design notes

Screen	Design note
S2 Home	The ambient orb should dominate the top half of the screen. It is the visual heartbeat of the app. Its current spirit reflects the last reflection. Below it: greeting text (large, "Good morning, Seya."), then Arc cards in horizontal scroll or 2-column grid.
S3 Chat	User messages: right-aligned, --bg-elevated bubble, --text-primary. Sage messages: LEFT-ALIGNED, NO BUBBLE — just floating text on --bg-primary. This visual asymmetry communicates that Sage is not a chatbot equal — it is a reflective presence. Input bar: --bg-elevated, rounded pill, mic icon left, send arrow right.
S4 Reflection	Full dark screen. Spirit centered and large (120px). Cascade animation as described above. The "A Shared Perspective" card uses a distinct soft border color to signal it is different — a community voice, not Sage. "Save Reflection & Continue" CTA at the very bottom.
S6 Arcs grid	Active arcs: full color. Archived arcs: dimmed to 40% opacity, grayscale filter. "Archived Chapters (n)" collapsible section divider between them.
S7 Arc Detail	Arc name is tappable inline → becomes TextField on tap → blurs to save. The emotional journey "snake" uses actual spirit icons (small, 20px) connected by a faint 0.5px line — not blank circles. Each icon is tappable to show that session's emotion + one-line summary.

Reference apps

- Linear — information density, dark mode, micro-interactions, no visual noise
- Raycast — command palette aesthetics, keyboard-first feel, speed
- Calm — soft ambient animations, non-clinical emotional palette
- Day One — journal entry card design, timeline layout
- Reflect — arc/threading concept, quiet design language